

DIRECTORS

Sir Archibald Forster BSc F Eng (Chairman)(Resigned 31st January 1993)
Mr K H Taylor BSc PhD C Eng (Appointed Chairman 1st February 1993)
Mr D Clayman BSc C Eng (Managing Director)
Mr J I Alcock BA MBA (Executive Director)
Mr P J Dingle BSc (Appointed 1st February 1993)

SECRETARY

Mr M F Westlake FCA (resigned 9th October 1992)
Mr A N Brown CA(SA) (appointed 9th October 1992)

REGISTERED OFFICE

Esso House
Victoria Street
London SW1E 5JW

AUDITORS

Price Waterhouse
Southwark Towers
32 London Bridge Street
London SE1 9SY



Esso Petroleum Company, Limited and subsidiaries

REPORT OF THE DIRECTORS

The Directors present their annual report and the audited accounts for the year ended 31 December 1992

CHAIRMAN

Sir Archibald Forster was Chairman of the Board of Directors throughout 1992. He resigned as Chairman on 31st January 1993 before retiring from the company on the 10th February 1993 when he attained normal retirement age. Mr K H Taylor was appointed as his successor on the 1st February 1993.

DIRECTORS

The present Directors of the Company are listed on page 1.
All the Directors retire at the Annual General Meeting and are eligible for re-election.

DIRECTORS' INTERESTS

During the year and in the period to 29 March 1993 none of the Directors had any interests in shares of any company of the Group such as would require to be disclosed in accordance with the provisions of Schedule 7 of the Companies Act 1985.

REVIEW OF THE BUSINESS

The principal activities of the Group are the refining, distribution and marketing of petroleum products in the United Kingdom. The principal subsidiaries of the Company at 31 December 1992 are listed in note 10 to the accounts.

Total United Kingdom oil demand in 1992 was down on 1991 due to the continuing recession and warmer than average temperatures. More competitive markets had a resultant downward pressure on prices.

FUTURE DEVELOPMENTS

The Group intends to remain a major refiner and marketer of petroleum products in the United Kingdom.

RESEARCH AND DEVELOPMENT

The Esso Research Centre near Abingdon is the focus of the petroleum products research effort in support of the Group's activities in the United Kingdom. The centre has a specialist responsibility to Exxon Corporation Worldwide for research into automotive and aviation fuels and engine lubricants. A comprehensive technical support service is provided, covering crude oils, industrial fuels and lubricants, bitumens and greases. The Centre also provides research and guidance to the Group on environmental matters and is the location for research by Exxon Chemical. The Group is also able to call on the extensive research and development resources of Exxon Corporation.

RESULTS AND DIVIDENDS

Group net profit for the year was £24.0 million. Dividends totalling £28 million were paid during the year with £4.0 million transferred from reserves, which remain at a high level of £370.5 million.

CHANGES IN FIXED ASSETS

Additions to fixed assets of the Group for the year amounted to £126.4 million. Net tangible assets were £1,556.8 million. Further details of fixed assets are provided in notes 8, 9 and 10 to the accounts.

DONATIONS

During 1992 the Group made total donations and other support to the community of £1,486,000. Of this, charitable donations amounted to £310,000. There were no political donations.

Esso Petroleum Company, Limited and subsidiaries

REPORT OF THE DIRECTORS

EMPLOYEE INVOLVEMENT

The Group has established over many years a comprehensive programme of employee communication and consultation. The Directors are committed to the continued involvement of employees in this way as an essential element in the Group remaining efficient and competitive. It is an integral part of management's responsibility to ensure that all employees understand the Group's objectives and the contribution that the individual can make to their achievement.

EMPLOYMENT POLICY

The Group is an equal opportunity employer and complies with all relevant legislation. It pays particular attention to measures which will encourage the employment and career development of both women and ethnic minorities.

The Group's policy is also to ensure that equal opportunities, including training, career development and promotion exist for disabled persons having regard to their particular aptitudes and abilities.

HEALTH AND SAFETY

The Group has a policy to conduct its business in a manner that protects the safety of the employees, others involved in its operations, customers and the public. The Group will strive to prevent all accidents, injuries and occupational illnesses through the active participation of every employee. The Group is committed to continuous efforts to identify and eliminate or manage safety risks associated with its activities.

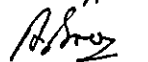
ENVIRONMENTAL POLICY

The Group has a policy to ensure that it conducts its business in a manner that is compatible with the balanced environmental and economic needs of the community. Further, it is the Group's policy to comply with all applicable environmental laws and regulations and apply responsible standards where laws or regulations do not exist.

AUDITORS

The auditors, Price Waterhouse, have signified their willingness to be re-appointed.

By Order of the Board,
A N Brown, Secretary, 29 March 1993

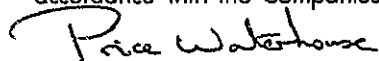


REPORT OF THE AUDITORS

To the members of Esso Petroleum Company, Limited.

We have audited the financial statements on pages 4 to 14 in accordance with Auditing Standards.

In our opinion the financial statements give a true and fair view of the state of affairs of the Company and the Group at 31 December 1992 and of the profit of the Company and the Group for the year then ended and have been properly prepared in accordance with the Companies Act 1985.



Price Waterhouse
Chartered Accountants
& Registered Auditor
29 March 1993

Southwark Towers
32 London Bridge Street
London SE1 9SY

Esso Petroleum Company, Limited and subsidiaries

ACCOUNTING POLICIES

These financial statements have been prepared in accordance with the Companies Act 1985 and applicable Accounting Standards in the United Kingdom and are based upon the historical cost convention, except where noted below with regard to fixed assets.

The company is a wholly owned subsidiary of Esso UK plc. FRS 1 exempts Esso Petroleum Company, Limited and subsidiaries from preparing a cash flow statement. Esso UK plc has prepared and filed a cash flow statement in accordance with FRS 1.

A summary of the main accounting policies which have been applied consistently is set out below.

BASIS OF CONSOLIDATION

The Group accounts incorporate the assets, liabilities, revenue and expenses, after adjusting for unrealised profits on intra-group transactions of the Company and its subsidiaries as shown by their accounts made up to 31 December 1992

FOREIGN CURRENCIES

Foreign currency balance sheet items are translated at rates prevailing at the year end. Foreign currency transaction differences are included in the appropriate profit and loss account categories.

FIXED ASSETS

CLASSIFICATION

Purchased goodwill arising on acquisitions is shown as an intangible asset. All other fixed assets are considered to be tangible.

ASSET VALUATIONS

Fixed assets are valued at cost or market value. Assets held under leases which transfer substantially all the benefits and risks of ownership to the lessee (finance leases) are included at a cost equivalent to the net present value of the lease payments.

DEPRECIATION AND AMORTISATION

Depreciation and amortisation are charged to reduce the cost of each group of assets to its residual value over its expected useful life. All assets are depreciated or amortised by equal annual instalments at rates ranging from 2 per cent to 25 per cent per annum, except for assets under construction and freehold land on which no depreciation is provided.

GOODWILL

Goodwill arising on acquisitions and recorded in the balance sheet is amortised through the profit and loss account. The Group amortises such purchased goodwill by equal annual instalments over the purchased goodwill's expected useful life, using rates between 5 and 10 per cent per annum.

STOCKS

Stocks are stated at the lower of cost or net realisable value. Cost is calculated using the first-in-first-out method, including an appropriate proportion of overheads.

PENSION COSTS

The Group operates a defined benefit pension plan, the assets of which are held in a separate trustee administered fund. Separate accounts are maintained within the plan for each participating company. The pension cost is charged to the profit and loss account so as to spread the cost over the service lives of the employees. Experience variations are spread over the average remaining service lives of current employees. The pension cost is assessed in accordance with advice of qualified actuaries.

RESEARCH AND DEVELOPMENT EXPENDITURE

Research and development expenditure is charged to income as incurred and is included in cost of sales.

DEFERRED TAX

Provision for deferred taxation is made using the liability method only to the extent that taxation is expected to be payable in the foreseeable future.

OPERATING LEASES

Operating lease payments are charged to the profit and loss account in the period to which they relate.

Esso Petroleum Company, Limited and subsidiaries

PROFIT AND LOSS ACCOUNTS

for the year ended 31 December

	Note	GROUP 1992 £m	1991 £m	COMPANY 1992 £m	1991 £m
Gross turnover		5,054.0	5,042.7	4,893.5	4,892.0
Excise duties and VAT		(2,647.5)	(2,555.7)	(2,590.0)	(2,502.9)
Net turnover	1	2,406.5	2,487.0	2,303.5	2,389.1
Cost of sales	2	(1,908.1)	(1,943.5)	(1,851.6)	(1,886.4)
Gross profit		498.4	543.5	451.9	502.7
Distribution costs	2	(344.9)	(376.8)	(314.6)	(353.5)
Administrative expenses	2	(38.0)	(36.9)	(37.9)	(36.7)
OPERATING PROFIT		115.5	129.8	99.4	112.5
Income from shares in group undertakings		0.0	0.0	22.6	10.4
Amounts written off investments	10	0.0	0.0	(13.9)	0.0
Interest receivable	3	17.2	30.9	18.1	32.4
Interest payable	4	(100.1)	(124.9)	(100.3)	(125.1)
PROFIT ON ORDINARY ACTIVITIES BEFORE TAXATION	5	32.6	35.8	25.9	30.2
Taxation on profit on ordinary activities	7	(6.0)	(6.3)	(0.4)	2.1
PROFIT ON ORDINARY ACTIVITIES AFTER TAXATION		26.6	29.5	25.5	32.3
Minority interest	16	(2.6)	(3.5)	0.0	0.0
PROFIT ATTRIBUTABLE TO SHAREHOLDERS		24.0	26.0	25.5	32.3
Amounts transferred from/(added to) reserves	18	4.0	(16.0)	2.5	(22.3)
DIVIDENDS PAID		28.0	10.0	28.0	10.0

The notes on page 4 and pages 7 to 14 form part of the accounts.

BALANCE SHEETS

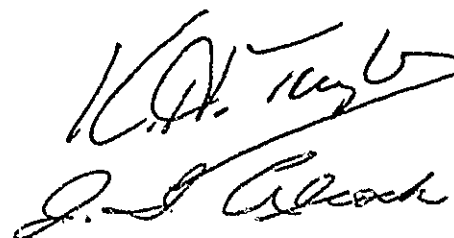
as at 31 December

	NOTE	GROUP 1992	1991	COMPANY 1992	1991
		£m	£m	£m	£m
FIXED ASSETS					
Intangible assets	8	20.0	21.7	1.1	0.6
Tangible assets	9	1,556.8	1,505.3	1,512.2	1,462.0
Investments	10	0.0	0.0	42.3	54.3
TOTAL FIXED ASSETS		1,576.8	1,527.0	1,555.6	1,516.9
CURRENT ASSETS					
Stocks	11	305.0	304.8	295.4	293.3
Debtors falling due within one year	12	291.6	225.6	313.4	235.0
Debtors falling due after more than one year	12	212.5	201.3	212.5	201.3
Cash at bank and in hand		17.5	25.2	16.6	22.8
TOTAL CURRENT ASSETS		826.6	756.9	837.9	752.4
CREDITORS FALLING DUE WITHIN ONE YEAR	13	(723.6)	(581.5)	(721.6)	(577.0)
NET CURRENT ASSETS		103.0	175.4	116.3	175.4
TOTAL ASSETS LESS CURRENT LIABILITIES		1,679.8	1,702.4	1,671.9	1,692.3
CREDITORS FALLING DUE AFTER MORE THAN ONE YEAR	13	742.6	761.4	742.6	760.5
PROVISIONS FOR LIABILITIES AND CHARGES	15	6.1	5.6	0.0	0.0
MINORITY INTERESTS	16	3.2	3.5	0.0	0.0
CAPITAL AND RESERVES					
Called up share capital	17	228.4	228.4	228.4	228.4
Revaluation reserve	18	329.0	330.1	329.0	330.1
Profit and loss account	18	370.5	373.4	371.9	373.3
TOTAL CAPITAL AND RESERVES		927.9	931.9	929.3	931.8
		1,679.8	1,702.4	1,671.9	1,692.3

The notes on page 4 and pages 7 to 14 form part of the financial accounts.

Mr K H Taylor Director
Mr J I Alcock Director

29 March 1993



Esso Petroleum Company, Limited and subsidiaries

NOTES TO THE ACCOUNTS

1 TURNOVER

Turnover consists of sales of crude oil, natural gas, petroleum products and related goods and services.

	GROUP		COMPANY	
	1992	1991	1992	1991
NET TURNOVER	£m	£m	£m	£m
U.K.	2,142.5	2,314.6	2,046.3	2,219.8
Europe	139.1	21.0	134.8	18.2
Rest of the World	124.9	151.4	122.4	151.1
TOTAL	2,406.5	2,487.0	2,303.5	2,389.1

The Group's turnover is all related to the oil and gas business.

2 CATEGORIES OF COSTS

COST OF SALES

Cost of sales represents the cost of crude oil, petroleum products and related goods and services sold during the year, including research and manufacturing costs, and the cost, including freight, of purchases from third parties.

DISTRIBUTION COSTS

Distribution costs represent the costs of marketing and transporting petroleum products and related goods and services.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXPENSES

Administrative expenses relate to expenses of general management and related staff activities pertaining to the administration of the overall business.

3 INTEREST RECEIVABLE

	GROUP		COMPANY	
	1992	1991	1992	1991
	£m	£m	£m	£m
Amounts receivable from group undertakings	14.9	28.4	16.2	29.9
Other	2.3	2.5	1.9	2.5
TOTAL	17.2	30.9	18.1	32.4

4 INTEREST PAYABLE

	GROUP		COMPANY	
	1992	1991	1992	1991
	£m	£m	£m	£m
Amounts payable to group undertakings	(95.4)	(119.6)	(95.8)	(120.0)
Other	(4.7)	(5.3)	(4.5)	(5.1)
TOTAL	(100.1)	(124.9)	(100.3)	(125.1)
Other interest comprises :				
Interest payable on bank and other borrowings				
repayable within five years	(1.4)	(1.0)	(1.2)	(0.8)
Interest payable on finance leases	(3.3)	(4.3)	(3.3)	(4.3)
TOTAL	(4.7)	(5.3)	(4.5)	(5.1)

Esso Petroleum Company, Limited and subsidiaries

NOTES TO THE ACCOUNTS

5 PROFIT ON ORDINARY ACTIVITIES BEFORE TAXATION	GROUP 1992	1991	COMPANY 1992	1991
	£m	£m	£m	£m
This is stated after charging the following amounts :				
Auditors' remuneration - audit fees	0.3	0.3	0.3	0.3
- other fees	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.1
Operating leases - hire of plant and machinery	6.7	6.8	6.3	6.5
- other	0.2	0.2	0.0	0.0
Depreciation and amortisation - owned assets	66.8	57.6	63.0	57.6
- assets held under finance leases	1.9	2.7	1.9	2.7
Research and development	11.1	9.8	11.0	9.7
Wages and salaries	132.8	128.1	127.0	123.5
Social security costs	10.1	9.8	9.6	9.5
Other pension costs (see note 6)	16.1	27.0	16.1	27.0
EMOLUMENTS	£000	£000	£000	£000
Aggregate pre-tax emoluments of chairman and other directors	467.2	448.4	467.2	448.4
Chairman's emoluments, excluding pension contributions	155.6	171.5	155.6	171.5
Emoluments of highest paid director, excluding pension contributions	173.9	186.2	173.9	186.2

Wages and salaries, social security and other pension costs shown above include amounts payable to employees seconded to Esso Exploration and Production UK Limited.

The number of directors including the chairman and the highest paid director who received emoluments (excluding pension contributions) in the following ranges is given in the table below. After tax incomes are shown at the mid-point of each band using appropriate 1992/1993 tax rates. For the purpose of the calculation recipients are assumed to be married with no other income.

GROSS INCOME	AFTER TAX	DIRECTORS	
£	£	1992	1991
10 001 - 15 000	10767	1	1
75 001 - 80 000	52061		1
80 001 - 85 000	55222	1	
155 001 - 160 000	100222	1	
170 001 - 175 000	109222	1	1
185 001 - 190 000	118222		1

6 PENSIONS

At December 1991 the market value of the assets of the fund was £516.4 million (1990 £469.1 million) and the actuarial value of the assets on the funding basis was sufficient to cover 110% (1990 115%) of the benefits that had accrued to members, after allowing for expected future increases in salaries. Pension costs for 1992 were £16.1 million (1991 £27.0 million). This decrease in pension costs reflects the lower cost of discretionary pension increases due to lower inflation. A prepayment of £65.9 million (1991 £58 million) in respect of pension costs is included in debtors. Contributions to the fund in 1992 represented 15% of pensionable pay, plus funding of increases to pensions in payment.

The latest full actuarial valuation of the scheme was at 31 December 1989. For accounting purposes the position is updated annually based on the projected unit credit method. The 1991 accounting valuation assumed that investment returns would be 2.5% (1990 2.5%) higher than salary increases, and that dividend growth would be 2.0% (1990 2.0%) lower than salary increases. No allowance was made for increases to pensions in payment.

Esso Petroleum Company, Limited and subsidiaries

NOTES TO THE ACCOUNTS

7 TAXATION ON PROFIT ON ORDINARY ACTIVITIES	GROUP 1992	1991	COMPANY 1992	1991
	£m	£m	£m	£m
UK Corporation Tax - Payable	(3.1)	(5.0)	0.0	0.0
- Prior years	(2.4)	(1.3)	(0.4)	2.1
- Deferred	(0.5)	0.0	0.0	0.0
TOTAL	(6.0)	(6.3)	(0.4)	2.1

Corporation tax has been calculated at 33% (1991, 33.25%). No Corporation Tax is payable on the profits of the Company in 1992.

Provision for deferred Corporation Tax has been made to the extent that liabilities are expected to crystallise as a result of reversing timing differences.

If a full deferred tax provision had been made, the total tax charge for 1992 would have been £32.9 million (1991, £7.4 million) compared with £6.0 million above.

8 INTANGIBLE ASSETS	GROUP £m		
	Goodwill	Other	Total
COSTS			
Balance at beginning of year	24.7	3.6	28.3
Additions	0.0	1.0	1.0
BALANCE AT END OF YEAR 1992	24.7	4.6	29.3
DEPRECIATION			
Balance at beginning of year	3.6	3.0	6.6
Charge for year	2.2	0.5	2.7
BALANCE AT END OF YEAR 1992	5.8	3.5	9.3
NET BOOK VALUE AT 31 DECEMBER 1992	18.9	1.1	20.0
NET BOOK VALUE AT 31 DECEMBER 1991	21.1	0.6	21.7

	COMPANY £m	
	Other	Total
COSTS		
Balance at beginning of year	3.6	3.6
Additions	1.0	1.0
BALANCE AT END OF YEAR 1992	4.6	4.6
DEPRECIATION		
Balance at beginning of year	3.0	3.0
Charge for year	0.5	0.5
BALANCE AT END OF YEAR 1992	3.5	3.5
NET BOOK VALUE AT 31 DECEMBER 1992	1.1	1.1
NET BOOK VALUE AT 31 DECEMBER 1991	0.6	0.6

Esso Petroleum Company, Limited and subsidiaries

NOTES TO THE ACCOUNTS

9 TANGIBLE ASSETS

GROUP
£m

	Land & Buildings	Plant & Equipment	Assets Under Construction	Total
COST OR VALUATION				
Balance at beginning of year	644.1	1,150.2	205.6	1,999.9
Additions / (net completions)	74.4	149.9	(97.9)	126.4
Revaluation reserve realised on disposal	(1.1)	0.0	0.0	(1.1)
Disposals	(2.5)	(28.7)	(0.3)	(31.5)
BALANCE AT END OF YEAR 1992	714.9	1,271.4	107.4	2,093.7
DEPRECIATION				
Balance at beginning of year	61.1	433.5	0.0	494.6
Charge for year	8.8	57.2	0.0	66.0
Disposals	(1.0)	(22.7)	0.0	(23.7)
BALANCE AT END OF YEAR 1992	68.9	468.0	0.0	536.9
NET BOOK VALUE AT 31 DECEMBER 1992	646.0	803.4	107.4	1,556.8
NET BOOK VALUE AT 31 DECEMBER 1991	583.0	716.7	205.6	1,505.3

COMPANY
£m

	Land & Buildings	Plant & Equipment	Assets Under Construction	Total
COST OR VALUATION				
Balance at beginning of year	637.8	1,068.6	202.5	1,908.9
Additions / (net completions)	74.2	144.9	(97.9)	121.2
Revaluation reserve realised on disposal	(1.1)	0.0	0.0	(1.1)
Disposals	(2.5)	(28.3)	(0.3)	(31.1)
BALANCE AT END OF YEAR 1992	708.4	1,185.2	104.3	1,997.9
DEPRECIATION				
Balance at beginning of year	60.3	386.6	0.0	446.9
Charge for year	8.8	53.4	0.0	62.2
Disposals	(1.0)	(22.4)	0.0	(23.4)
BALANCE AT END OF YEAR 1992	68.1	417.6	0.0	485.7
NET BOOK VALUE AT 31 DECEMBER 1992	640.3	767.6	104.3	1,512.2
NET BOOK VALUE AT 31 DECEMBER 1991	577.5	682.0	202.5	1,462.0

Esso Petroleum Company, Limited and subsidiaries

NOTES TO THE ACCOUNTS

9 TANGIBLE ASSETS (Continued)

Included in the tangible assets for both Group and Company are assets with a net book value of £3.4 million (1991 £1.0 million) which have been identified as surplus to requirements, assets with a net book value of £28.4 million (1991, £30.3 million) held under finance leases, and £35.4 million (1991, £40.7 million) of assets subject to an option agreement which allows the lessor to purchase them for a nominal amount should there be any interruption in loan payments.

As at 31 December 1989 certain assets with a historical cost of £67 million were revalued to £398 million by a member of the Royal Institute of Chartered Surveyors employed by Esso Petroleum Company Limited, to open market values for existing use. The Directors have reviewed this valuation and at 31 December 1992 consider it still to be appropriate. The movement in the reserve reflects site disposals during the year.

NET BOOK VALUE OF LAND AND BUILDINGS COMPRISES:

	GROUP		COMPANY	
	1992	1991	1992	1991
	£m	£m	£m	£m
Freehold	584.4	539.6	578.9	534.4
Long Leasehold	24.5	24.9	24.5	24.9
Short Leasehold	37.1	18.5	36.9	18.2
	646.0	583.0	640.3	577.5

10 INVESTMENTS

	COMPANY
	Shares in
	Group
	Companies
	£m
Cost	
Balance at beginning of year	54.3
Additions	1.9
Write Down of Investments	(13.2)
BALANCE AT END OF YEAR 1992	42.3

Details of companies in which the Group holds more than 10% of any class of equity share capital or more than of the total allotted share capital are given below:

NAME OF COMPANY	Country of Registration	Class of Shares	Proportion of Shares & Voting Rights
Armley Road Services Limited	England and Wales	Ordinary	100%
Bridgework Limited	England and Wales	Ordinary	100%
Cleveland Petroleum Company Limited	England and Wales	Ordinary	100%
Comma Oil and Chemicals Limited	England and Wales	Ordinary	100%
Dart Oil Company Limited	England and Wales	Ordinary	100%
Esso Marine U.K. Limited	England and Wales	Ordinary	100%
Esso Pension Trust Limited	England and Wales	Ordinary	100%
Essogas Limited	England and Wales	Ordinary	100%
F & F Robinson (Service) Limited	England and Wales	Ordinary	100%
Ironbrace Limited	England and Wales	Ordinary	100%
Mainline Pipelines Limited	England and Wales	Ordinary	65%
Mode Wheel Property Limited	England and Wales	Ordinary	74.9%
Redline Oil Services Limited	England and Wales	Ordinary	100%
Retail Petroleum Services Limited	England and Wales	Ordinary	100%
Saygas Limited	England and Wales	Ordinary	100%
Sigas Limited	England and Wales	Ordinary	100%
Stansted Fuelling Company Limited	England and Wales	Ordinary	14.29%

The above list comprises the principal subsidiaries of the Company, the accounts of which have been included in the Group accounts. All the subsidiaries operate in the United Kingdom and have principal activities related to the oil and gas industry.

F & F Robinson (Service) Limited, Retail Petroleum Services Ltd and Stanstead Fuelling Company Limited were acquired during the year ended 31 December 1992.

Esso Petroleum Company, Limited and subsidiaries

NOTES TO THE ACCOUNTS

11 STOCKS	GROUP 1992	1991	COMPANY 1992	1991
	£m	£m	£m	£m
Raw materials and consumables	86.5	68.4	86.1	68.2
Work in progress	46.3	40.9	46.3	40.9
Finished goods and goods for resale	172.2	195.5	163.0	184.2
TOTAL	305.0	304.8	295.4	293.3

The replacement cost of all categories of stocks held by the group at 31 December 1992 was £306.1 million.

12 DEBTORS	GROUP 1992	1991	COMPANY 1992	1991
	£m	£m	£m	£m
AMOUNTS FALLING DUE WITHIN ONE YEAR				
Trade debtors	182.5	170.4	174.1	161.4
Amounts owed by group undertakings	84.8	28.3	117.8	44.4
Other debtors	6.8	6.8	4.3	3.5
Prepayments and accrued income	17.5	20.1	17.2	25.7
TOTAL	291.6	225.6	313.4	235.0
AMOUNTS FALLING DUE AFTER ONE YEAR				
Other debtors	35.6	31.3	63.0	31.3
Prepayments and accrued income	176.9	170.0	149.5	170.0
TOTAL	212.5	201.3	212.5	201.3

Included in the Company 'Amounts owed by group undertakings' is £33m (1991, £16.2m) due from subsidiaries.

13 CREDITORS	GROUP 1992	1991	COMPANY 1992	1991
	£m	£m	£m	£m
AMOUNTS FALLING DUE WITHIN ONE YEAR				
Bank loans and overdrafts	44.3	11.2	44.3	11.2
Obligations under finance leases	7.8	4.0	7.8	4.0
Trade creditors	125.4	172.2	121.9	165.4
Amounts owed to group undertakings - trade accounts	77.2	26.7	166.2	36.9
- short term loans	262.1	130.6	185.0	130.6
Other creditors	2.8	0.3	0.0	0.3
Taxation and social security	199.1	233.5	191.5	225.6
Accruals and deferred income	4.9	3.0	4.9	3.0
TOTAL	723.6	581.5	721.6	577.0
AMOUNTS FALLING DUE AFTER MORE THAN ONE YEAR				
Long and medium term loans (note 14)	734.5	756.9	734.5	756.0
Accruals and deferred income	8.1	4.5	8.1	4.5
TOTAL	742.6	761.4	742.6	760.5

Included in the Company 'Amounts owed to group undertakings' is £12.5m (1991, £10.3m) due to subsidiaries.

14 LONG AND MEDIUM TERM LOANS	GROUP 1992	1991	COMPANY 1992	1991
	£m	£m	£m	£m
REPAYABLE IN ONE TO FIVE YEARS				
Obligations under finance leases	22.0	30.1	22.0	30.1
Amounts owed to group undertakings	695.1	705.3	695.1	705.3
REPAYABLE AFTER FIVE YEARS				
Obligations under purchase arrangements secured on certain service stations	0.1	1.1	0.1	0.2
Obligations under finance leases	17.3	20.4	17.3	20.4
TOTAL	734.5	756.9	734.5	756.0

Esso Petroleum Company, Limited and subsidiaries

NOTES TO THE ACCOUNTS

15 PROVISIONS FOR LIABILITIES AND CHARGES	GROUP 1992	1991	COMPANY 1992	1991
	£m	£m	£m	£m
DEFERRED TAXATION				
Balance at beginning of year	5.2	5.6	0.0	0.0
Charge against profit	0.5	0.0	0.0	0.0
BALANCE AT END OF YEAR	6.1	5.6	0.0	0.0
Analysis of total deferred taxation:				
Capital allowances in excess of depreciation	6.1	5.6	0.0	0.0
TOTAL	6.1	5.6	0.0	0.0

The potential amount of deferred taxation payable for all timing differences at the end of 1992 was as follows:

	GROUP 1992	1991	COMPANY 1992	1991
	£m	£m	£m	£m
Capital allowances in excess of depreciation	186.6	160.2	178.3	152.4
Other timing differences	34.2	33.2	33.4	33.8
TOTAL	220.8	193.4	211.7	186.2

16 MINORITY INTEREST

	GROUP £m
Balance at beginning of year	3.5
Current year profit	2.6
Dividends paid	(2.9)
BALANCE AT END OF YEAR 1992	3.2

17 CALLED UP SHARE CAPITAL AT BEGINNING AND END OF YEAR

Ordinary shares of £1 each - authorised	229 000 000
- allotted and fully paid	228 385 200

18 RESERVES

	GROUP £m	COMPANY £m
Profit and loss account		
Balance at beginning of year	373.4	373.3
Amounts transferred from reserves	(4.0)	(2.5)
Transfer from revaluation reserve	1.1	1.1
BALANCE AT END OF YEAR 1992	370.5	371.9

	GROUP £m	COMPANY £m
Revaluation reserve		
Balance at beginning of year	330.1	330.1
Amount transferred to profit and loss account on disposal	(1.1)	(1.1)
BALANCE AT END OF YEAR 1992	329.0	329.0

Esso Petroleum Company, Limited and subsidiaries

NOTES TO THE ACCOUNTS

19 CAPITAL COMMITMENTS	GROUP 1992	1991	COMPANY 1992	1991
	£m	£m	£m	£m
Estimated commitments under contracts for capital expenditure not provided for in these accounts amounted to	23.6	14.7	22.7	14.7
Capital expenditure additionally authorised by the directors as at 31 December amounted to	119.7	121.5	117.8	117.0
TOTAL	143.3	136.2	140.5	131.7

20 COMMITMENTS UNDER OPERATING LEASES	GROUP 1992	1991	COMPANY 1992	1991
	LAND AND BUILDINGS	OTHER	LAND AND BUILDINGS	OTHER
	£m	£m	£m	£m
At 31 December annual commitments under operating leases were as follows:				
Operating leases which expire:				
Within one year	0.5	0.0	0.2	0.0
In one to five years	1.5	1.5	0.2	1.2
After five years	3.7	0.0	3.5	0.0
TOTAL	5.7	1.5	3.9	1.2

	COMPANY 1992	1991	COMPANY 1992	1991
	LAND AND BUILDINGS	OTHER	LAND AND BUILDINGS	OTHER
	£m	£m	£m	£m
At 31 December annual commitments under operating leases were as follows:				
Operating leases which expire:				
Within one year	0.5	0.0	0.2	0.0
In one to five years	1.3	1.1	0.0	0.9
After five years	3.7	0.0	3.5	0.0
TOTAL	5.5	1.1	3.7	0.9

21 CONTINGENT LIABILITIES	GROUP 1992	1991	COMPANY 1992	1991
	£m	£m	£m	£m
Guarantees	3.8	4.8	3.8	4.8
TOTAL	3.8	4.8	3.8	4.8

22 EMPLOYEES	GROUP 1992	1991	COMPANY 1992	1991
The average number of persons employed during the year was:				
Marketing, Refining and Transportation	3,884	3,932	3,512	3,600
Assigned to Esso Exploration and Production UK Limited	291	294	291	294
TOTAL	4,175	4,226	3,803	3,894

23 ULTIMATE HOLDING COMPANY

The immediate holding company is Esso UK plc, incorporated and registered in England and Wales.
The ultimate holding company is Exxon Corporation incorporated and registered in New Jersey, USA.
The smallest group of which the company is a member and for which group accounts are prepared is Esso UK plc.
Accounts can be obtained from Esso UK plc, Esso House, Victoria Street, London SW1E 5JW.
The largest group of which the company is a member and for which consolidated accounts are prepared is the Exxon Corporation. Accounts can be obtained from Exxon Corporation, 225 Shareholder Relations, Post Office Box 160369, Irving, Texas 75016-0369, USA.